

Cristian Garza

OSCP CERTIFIED PENETRATION TESTER | SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Houston, Texas

✉ garzacristianm@gmail.com | 🏠 CristianGarza.github.io | 📱 cristian-garza-6b639b14b

Professional Summary

OSCP-certified penetration tester with 4+ years of professional software engineering experience across full-stack development, cloud infrastructure (AWS, Docker), and cybersecurity research tooling. Lab-tested in Active Directory exploitation, web application attacks, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation across Windows and Linux through OSCP coursework, HackTheBox, and self-built AD environments. Engineering background means I read code and infrastructure the way it was written — and the way an attacker will read it.

Experience

Texas Center for Cell Therapy and Research

San Antonio, Texas | Remote

CYBERSECURITY CONSULTANT

Sep. 2025 – Present

- Self-directed OSCP preparation alongside the role: 300+ hours of hands-on training in Active Directory exploitation, web application attacks, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation across Windows and Linux.
- Hardened endpoints by deploying BitLocker full-disk encryption and enforcing secure baseline configurations across all employee devices.
- Set up email domain, hosting, and basic authentication for the organization's small team.

CyManII (Cybersecurity Manufacturing Innovation Institute)

San Antonio, TX

SYSTEMS SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Dec. 2023 – Sep. 2025

- Developed software tools supporting cybersecurity research targeting industrial control systems (ICS) and manufacturing environments.
- Built containerized lab environments with Docker and Docker Swarm to simulate target infrastructure for security research workflows.
- Designed automated testing and validation pipelines in Python and JavaScript, cutting QA overhead and enabling reproducible research.
- Collaborated with DOE national labs, academic researchers, and industry partners on cybersecurity resilience projects for critical infrastructure.
- Contributed to internal research documentation and knowledge sharing across multi-organization teams.

Cariloop

Remote

FULL STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Jul. 2021 – Apr. 2023

- Developed and maintained full-stack web applications using TypeScript, Angular, and Loopback 4 in an agile environment, building first-hand familiarity with the modern web stack from a defender's and attacker's perspective.
- Designed and implemented RESTful backend services and third-party integrations while adhering to secure development practices (input validation, authentication, authorization).
- Deployed and managed production applications on AWS using Docker, Linux, and Nginx, ensuring high availability.
- Participated in code reviews and contributed to engineering standards to improve code quality and reduce security defects.

Infosys

Remote

SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT INTERN

Jun. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- Built an internal HR hiring application within Microsoft Teams using HTML, Bash, Azure, and SharePoint.
- Integrated automated workflows to streamline candidate tracking and reduce manual HR processes.
- Documented findings and regularly presented project updates to stakeholders and management.

Hands-On Security Projects

Independent Research

cristiangarza.github.io/writeups

HACKTHEBOX & OFFENSIVE SECURITY LAB WRITE-UPS

Ongoing

- **Pilgrimage (Linux):** Chained an exposed .git repository disclosure (git-dumper) with an ImageMagick file-read CVE to obtain database credentials, then escalated to root by exploiting a vulnerable inotifywait/binwalk monitoring pipeline.
- **Jarvis (Linux):** Exploited SQL injection (manual and via sqlmap) for initial foothold, escalated through command injection in a sudo-permitted ping utility, and gained root via an abusable systemd service unit.
- **Chatterbox (Windows):** Developed a custom buffer overflow exploit against an outdated Achat service for user-level RCE, then leveraged credential reuse over SMB with Impacket to achieve privileged code execution.
- Maintain self-built Active Directory lab environments for practicing Kerberos attacks, lateral movement, and BloodHound-based attack path analysis.

Certifications

2026 **Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP)**, Offensive Security

2023 **CompTIA Security+**, CompTIA

Education

The University of Texas at Austin

B.S. COMPUTER SCIENCE, CYBERSECURITY CONCENTRATION

Austin, TX

May 2021

Technical Skills

Offensive Security & Exploitation

Recon, Scanning & Cracking

Areas of Focus

Programming & Scripting

Infrastructure & Cloud

Web Technologies

Methodologies & Frameworks

Burp Suite, Metasploit, BloodHound, Impacket, Mimikatz, SQLMap, NetExec

Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus, OpenVAS, Hashcat, Kali Linux, PowerShell

Active Directory exploitation, Web App Assessment, Lateral Movement, CVEs

Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Bash, C/C++, Java

AWS, Docker, Docker Swarm, Linux, Windows, Active Directory, Nginx, Container Security

Angular, React, Loopback 4, SQL, MongoDB

OWASP Top 10, MITRE ATT&CK, CVSS, PTES, NIST SP 800-115